



Ludwig van Beethoven, one of the greatest of musicians was born Dec. 17, 1770, in Bonn-on-the-Rhine, Germany. His father, a tenor singer in the village choir, was very cruel and used to beat the boy sometimes when he did not practise. His mother was kind and patient. Her death, when he was seventeen years old, brought him sorrow which he never seemed to forget. When still a boy, he was made assistant organist in the cathedral, a position which he held until 1792. He also played second viola in the theatre orchestra. One day when he was on a visit to Vienna, he met Mozart who was so impressed with Beethoven's playing that he exclaimed: "He will give the world something worth listening to."

Beethoven loved to wander through the cool forest, listen to the voices of nature and compose his music in such surroundings. At the age of thirty, he began to grow deaf and in later years, he was unable to hear his own compositions.

Romanze

from 5th Sonata

Beethoven (1770-1827)

Moderato

mp

Dom. 7th

cresc.

dim.

Dom. 7th

Dom. 7th

A Grace Note is a little note used as an ornament. It has no time value and should be "flicked" into the principal note which follows as quickly as possible. It is always shown as a small note with a slanting line drawn through its stem, thus, ♪.